

Module 08: Planning — The Squirrel's Winter Plan

Learning Objectives

1. Understand what **Planning** is (thinking about the future).
2. Learn how to choose the best path to reach your goal.
3. See how predicting helps us avoid bad surprises (like being hungry in winter!).

Introduction: The Squirrel's Winter Plan

Nutty the Squirrel looked at the leaves falling. He knew winter was coming. **Goal:** Have a full tummy all winter. **Surprise to Avoid:** Being hungry!

Nutty had two choices:

1. **Play all day:** Fun now, but hungry later.
2. **Gather nuts:** Hard work now, but happy later.

Nutty put on his Thinking Cap. He imagined the future. "If I play, I will be cold and hungry. That is a bad surprise!" "If I work, I will be warm and full. That is a good plan!"

So, Nutty gathered nuts. When winter came, he was cozy and full. Good planning, Nutty!

Key Concepts

1. What is Planning?

Planning is using your map to visit the future *before* you go there.

- You don't have to experience the bad surprise (hunger) to learn.
- You can *imagine* it and choose a different path!

2. Choosing Paths

Imagine a maze. You can go Left or Right.

- **Left Path:** Leads to a tiger. (Scary!)
- **Right Path:** Leads to a strawberry. (Yummy!)
- **Planning:** Choosing the Right Path because you predict it makes you happier.

3. Deep Thinking

Planning is like a superpower. It lets you see what *might* happen.

- "If I don't brush my teeth -> Cavities!" (I will brush.)
- "If I share my toys -> More friends!" (I will share.)

Activities

Activity 1: The Weekend Plan

Draw a picture of what you want to do this weekend. Now, draw *how* you will make it happen. (Want to go to the park? Plan: Ask Mom, put on shoes, bring ball.)

Activity 2: The Maze Game

Draw a maze on paper. Use your finger to trace the paths *without* drawing. Find the dead ends in your head first. That is planning!

Summary

Planning is thinking ahead. We use our maps to imagine the future and choose the actions that keep us safe and happy. Because Nutty planned, he had a great winter. You can be a planner too!

References

- *The Ant and the Grasshopper* (An Aesop Fable about planning vs. playing.)

- *If You Give a Mouse a Cookie* by Laura Numeroff (A funny chain of events!)